

# Kamal Joshi

## Senior Backend Engineer | Go | Distributed Systems | AWS | Terraform | Platform Engineering

Austin, TX | Open to remote-friendly and hybrid roles | Open to relocation for the right opportunity  
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### PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior backend and platform engineer with deep experience designing, operating, and scaling distributed systems that run under real production constraints. Proven record of end-to-end ownership — from API design and data modeling through Terraform-managed infrastructure, incident response, and multi-region reliability. Strong in Go and AWS; treats infrastructure as a core part of the product. Known for translating complex, cross-functional constraints into clean system design, making architectural decisions with imperfect information, and driving outcomes with urgency. Fluent in AI-assisted engineering workflows (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Codex) across implementation, IaC, testing, and design exploration.

### CORE STRENGTHS

- **Backend engineering:** Go, Java, REST, gRPC, JSON/HTTP APIs, webhooks, event-driven architecture, microservices, distributed systems
- **Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS (ECS, EKS, Lambda, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager, S3, Kinesis), Terraform modules, multi-account infrastructure, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD
- **Infrastructure as code:** Terraform-managed multi-region rollouts, staged sovereign environment deployments, IaC as a first-class engineering concern
- **Production ownership:** DLQ recovery, incident response, multi-region HA, rate-limit governance, deployment validation, observability instrumentation
- **Workflow and coordination systems:** event-driven orchestration (SQS/SNS/DynamoDB streams), cross-service async workflows, operational process automation
- **Engineering leadership:** system design, architecture standards, cross-functional collaboration, production incident ownership, mentoring
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex across implementation, IaC, testing, debugging, and code review

### EXPERIENCE

#### Cisco

##### Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - Present | Austin, TX

- Owned backend platform systems including **API Gateway**, **Authorization Service**, and **Third-Party Integrations Service** — accountable for reliability, scalability, and cross-team architectural standards.
- Prevented production message loss during a webhook incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and orchestrating a full redrive within **5-10 minutes** — with zero data loss.
- Drove integrations-svc production readiness across **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged changes across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, service config, and audit logging, validating HA behavior across at least two regions.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ device registration requests** through API key authentication and APIGW rate-limit behavior, unblocking the customer and driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Led design and delivery of push security events capability using the open **CloudEvents** standard, delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers — real-time event delivery to customer systems.
- **Diagnosed and fixed a critical third-party integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation**, restoring confidence in the product and contributing directly to the purchase decision.

- Made foundational architectural decisions on system design, service boundaries, and data models for the integrations platform; set engineering standards adopted across the broader APIX team.

### **Senior Software Engineer**

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Advanced platform capabilities across API gateway, authorization, integrations, and event-delivery domains; grew into full production ownership for backend services.
- Built **auth-tools**, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services to standardize OAuth/policy enforcement integration.
- Implemented metrics instrumentation for Authorization Service and Integrations Service, enabling production observability and SLO tracking.
- Integrated AI tooling (Claude Code, Copilot, Codex) across the full SDLC — implementation, IaC authoring, test generation, and code review; pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco initiatives.

### **Randstad Technologies US at Cisco**

#### **Senior Software Developer**

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs for a cloud-native data ingestion platform.
- Built API-driven authentication and authorization flows using OIDC, OAuth 2.0, and gRPC-Web.
- Contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs and gRPC APIs from SQL schemas.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

### **Earlier Engineering Experience**

**Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera** | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, workflow applications, and integration features across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector domains.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, automation, and maintainable engineering practices before moving into cloud-native platform work.

### **CERTIFICATIONS**

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

### **EDUCATION**

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology  
Dharmsinh Desai University